

July 15, 2026

Latitude AI Hiring Team

2545 Railroad Street, Suite 400 | Pittsburgh, PA 15222

RE: Senior Autonomy Integration Engineer

Latitude is building a vertically integrated autonomy platform toward a 2027 vehicle launch. The work described in this role is not simply debugging or configuration management. It is the discipline of making specialized teams, hardware, software, evidence, and ownership behave as one launchable system. That is why I am applying.

My career has repeatedly placed me at the seams of complex systems: software-enabled robotics and machine vision at Vape-Jet; regulated autonomous drone operations at ZeusVu; high-reliability electronics, root cause, and quality systems at Compunetics; and 24/7 launch mechanisms at Amazon. Across those environments, I have been most useful when the visible symptom crossed formal ownership boundaries and the organization needed a bounded reproduction, a clear operating decision, and a durable mechanism rather than a temporary workaround.

I have made that reasoning visible in an independent candidate vision at russelldudek.github.io/latitude/. The System Coherence Frame treats platform configuration, compute and network, sensing and actuation, autonomy software, validation evidence, and ownership as coupled layers. The accompanying closure record, interview brief, and 90-day plan show how I would enter the work: learn Latitude specific failure language, own bounded integration problems, and convert repeated friction into stronger tests, configuration lineage, and handoffs.

The strongest objection is legitimate: I do not claim verified senior production C++ experience or prior ownership of an automotive autonomy stack. I would rather expose that gap than decorate it. My proposal is a realistic, bounded technical case during the interview process. I will make assumptions explicit, reproduce the failure, connect evidence across domains, respect technical authority, and show how I learn in code and systems.

Latitude needs engineers who can move from architecture to the weeds without losing the whole system. I would welcome the opportunity to demonstrate that operating range in Pittsburgh.

Carpe diem,

Russell Dudek

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